or learn something from (I forget the details completely) a member of the Anatomy Department. I went down to the anatomy lab for the purpose, and while waiting there I relaxed by leaning against a flat table on which a life-size wax figure rested.

Slowly, by the diffusion inward of I don't know what enlightenment, I began to realize what an anatomy laboratory was, and what the wax figure was. It was a cadaver—a dead human being.

I didn't disgrace myself. I didn't start back or turn sick. I merely continued to wait, with my eyes fixed firmly on the floor, completed my errand, and left. I never went back into the anatomy lab in all the time I was at the Medical School. I never saw another cadaver.

And to think I had tried to get into medical school as a student fifteen years before! I daresay I would have grown accustomed to dissection and learned to eat my lunch in the presence of human fragments, as I had once learned to do in the presence of cat fragments—but I'm glad I never had to learn to violate my own personal set of instincts.

18

On the afternoon of April 7, I called Bea Mahaffey, who was editor of Universe Science Fiction, and whose office was in Evanston, just to the north of Chicago. It seemed to me that I had to balance the deadliness of a scientific convention with some science-fictional light-heartedness (and Bea was pretty enough to make me feel very light-hearted indeed).

She asked me to write a story for her, and in a fit of expansiveness,

I asked her to bring me a typewriter, never dreaming she would take my grandiloquence seriously—but she brought me a typewriter.

I wasn't man enough to admit I had been boasting, not to a girl as pretty as Bea, so there was nothing to do but sit down and type out a story on the spur. Since the attempted climbing of Mount Everest was much in the news in those days, it occurred to me to explain the repeated failures by postulating the Abominable Snowmen to be Martians. It was a short, reasonably clever story, about 1,300 words long.

Bea read it as it came out of the typewriter, and bought it on the spot—with the provision that her co-editor, Raymond }. Palmer, approve. As it happened, he did, and I eventually received $39 for the story. (Palmer was the man who